

Another consideration is whether to purchase an ultrabook with a detachable tablet screen? In our experience, such products remain as a niche right now, and even users aren't lapping up 2-in-1 convertibles or tablet-ultrabook hybrid devices in a hurry mainly because of their expensive price tags right now.

However, if price isn't an issue, and if you desire the novelty and flexibility of such a hybrid device, by all means pursue them. We even witnessed some of the best Intel and Windows 8 Convertibles at Computex 2013 last month, and you can find out more about them at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/slideshows/>.

Tablets & Smartphones

In the matter of tablets and smartphones, the specs to look out for are quite similar. Since we've covered SoCs and other underlying hardware characteristics of ARM-based devices in a previous chapter, we won't be going into much detail about it here. But suffice to say that when you're talking about a tablet or smartphone's processing chip, the latest hardware is always the best. Quad-core is better than dual-core, 2 GB RAM is better than 1 GB RAM. And as smartphones and tablets gain popularity as a compact computer, so does the need for them to be fast and packed with the latest and greatest hardware features that much more important -- especially with tablets. Because, remember this important point about tablets and smartphones -- unlike PCs or laptops, it is difficult to service their parts as most of them (except the battery) are soldered onto the PCB. So whenever you buy a smartphone or tablet, just stretch your budget a bit and get the best possible hardware configuration that you can afford at any point in time.

Other than that, here are two specs that you should pay special attention to and matter a lot:

Display: The manufacturers have gravitated and frozen upon two form factors, as far as tablets are concerned: 7-inch and 10-inch. While the 7-inch tablet does offer a huge advantage in terms of portability, the 10-inch form factor is better for multimedia and gaming experience. As far as smartphones go, 4-inch screens have become the lowest benchmark, and there are all sorts of variations being adopted in smartphone screens that take them very close to the tablet territory -- the 6.5-inch ASUS Fonepad, for example. In terms of pixel resolution, aim for a 720p display at the very minimum, and 1080p ones if you can afford. As you'll be staring at